MODULE II: RECRUITMENT

19. Meaning of Recruitment

Recruitment is the process of identifying potential candidates, attracting them to apply for a job and creating a pool of applicants from which suitable candidates can later be selected.

Recruitment is therefore an attraction activity. It does not end with choosing the employee. Selection follows recruitment and involves assessing candidates against job requirements.

Recruitment vs Selection
Recruitment asks: How can we attract enough suitable applicants? Selection asks: Which applicant(s) best meet the job requirements?

20. Recruitment Process

1. Identify a vacancy or future requirement through HRP.

2. Review job analysis and finalise job description and job specification.

3. Decide whether the vacancy should be filled internally, externally or through a combination.

4. Choose recruitment sources and communication channels.

5. Prepare the recruitment message/advertisement.

6. Receive and manage applications.

7. Screen applications against basic eligibility criteria.

8. Prepare a shortlist for the selection stage.

9. Communicate with candidates and conduct selection activities.

10. Make the appointment and begin pre-employment formalities/onboarding.

21. Factors Affecting Recruitment

• Organisational factors: size, reputation, pay structure, working conditions, culture, career opportunities and employer brand.

• Job factors: nature of work, qualifications, location, working hours, risk and career prospects.

• Labour-market conditions: availability of skills, competition for talent and prevailing wages.

• Economic conditions: growth, recession, inflation and business confidence can affect hiring.

• Government and legal requirements: applicable employment rules and equal-opportunity obligations must be considered.

• Recruitment budget: advertising, agency fees, travel, assessment and technology costs.

• Time pressure: urgent vacancies may require faster channels, but speed should not undermine quality and fairness.

• Technology: digital platforms can widen reach but may also create large volumes of applications requiring effective screening.

22. Internal Sources of Recruitment

Internal recruitment means filling vacancies from within the organisation. Common sources include promotion, transfer, internal job posting, employee referrals and succession pipelines.

Source	Advantages	Limitations
Promotion	Motivates employees; retains organisational knowledge	May create another vacancy; limited new perspectives
Transfer	Useful for redeployment and development	May not solve the overall staffing shortage
Internal Job Posting	Transparent access to opportunities	Applicant pool remains internal
Employee Referral	Can be fast and low-cost	Risk of similarity bias if poorly managed
Succession Pipeline	Supports continuity in critical roles	Requires long-term development

23. External Sources of Recruitment

External recruitment seeks candidates from outside the organisation. Sources include campus recruitment, employment websites, professional networks, recruitment agencies, advertisements, job fairs, social media and direct applications.

Source	Suitable When	Potential Concern
Campus recruitment	Entry-level and graduate positions	Candidates may have limited work experience

Source	Suitable When	Potential Concern
Online job portals	Large and geographically diverse applicant pools	High application volume
Recruitment agencies	Specialised or urgent hiring	Agency fees and quality variation
Professional networks	Specialist and experienced roles	May reach a narrower pool
Job fairs	High-volume or local recruitment	Requires planning and coordination
Employee referrals	Fast access to networks	Need safeguards against favouritism

24. Internal vs External Recruitment

Basis	Internal	External
Talent pool	Existing employees	Outside labour market
Speed	Often faster	May take longer
Cost	Usually lower	Can be higher
Organisational knowledge	High	Must be developed
New ideas	Moderate	Potentially higher
Employee motivation	Can support career growth	Depends on context
Best use	Promotion, succession, redeployment	New skills, expansion, specialist talent

25. E-Recruitment

E-recruitment refers to using digital technologies to attract, communicate with and manage job applicants. It may include organisation career pages, online job portals, professional networking sites, applicant tracking systems, online application forms, virtual career fairs and digital assessments.

Advantages of E-Recruitment

• Wide geographical reach.

• Fast communication and application processing.

• Lower distribution cost for many types of vacancies.

• Searchable applicant data and easier record management.

• Better integration with applicant tracking systems.

• Potential to improve candidate convenience and employer visibility.

Limitations and Risks

• Very high application volumes can increase screening burden.

• Digital access differences may exclude some applicants.

• Automated screening can reproduce bias if criteria or data are poorly designed.

• Privacy and data-security requirements must be respected.

• Online communication can make the candidate experience impersonal if poorly managed.

26. Inclusive Recruitment

Inclusive recruitment aims to ensure that recruitment practices provide fair opportunity to suitably qualified people and reduce avoidable barriers or bias. The objective is not to lower job standards; it is to make job-related standards clearer and the process fairer.

• Use clear, job-related selection criteria.

• Avoid unnecessary qualifications that are not genuinely required.

• Use inclusive and understandable language in job advertisements.

• Provide reasonable accessibility arrangements where appropriate.

• Use consistent screening criteria for all applicants.

• Use structured interviews and scoring guides to reduce arbitrary decisions.

• Train recruiters and interviewers to recognise common biases.

• Monitor applicant and selection outcomes where lawful and appropriate.

Example of inclusive wording
Instead of writing “young, energetic male required,” a job advertisement should describe the actual requirements, such as “the role involves frequent customer interaction and occasional travel; candidates must be able to meet the stated job requirements.”

27. Recruitment Advertisement: Model

Position: Junior Accounts Executive

Purpose: Support routine accounting, reconciliation, documentation and reporting.

Key responsibilities: Maintain records, assist with reconciliations, prepare routine reports, support GST/accounting documentation and coordinate with internal departments.

Essential requirements: Relevant commerce qualification; basic accounting knowledge; working knowledge of spreadsheets; attention to detail.

Desirable: Internship or practical exposure to accounting software.

How to apply: Submit the required application through the organisation’s specified channel.

This example demonstrates an important principle: the advertisement should communicate enough information for candidates to judge whether the role matches their qualifications and expectations.

28. Illustrative Case Study: The Campus Hiring Problem

Situation: A medium-sized finance company needs 20 graduate trainees. HR receives 2,000 applications through an online portal. The recruitment team initially plans to shortlist candidates solely on graduation marks.

Problem: Marks alone may not capture communication, numerical reasoning, teamwork or role-specific capability. At the same time, manually reading 2,000 applications is costly.

Discussion: Students should design a two-stage process: basic eligibility screening followed by a job-related assessment and structured interview. They should also discuss how an applicant tracking system could support administration without replacing human judgement completely.

MODULE III: SELECTION

29. Meaning of Selection

Selection is the process of evaluating applicants and choosing the person or persons who best meet the requirements of a job and the organisation.

Selection should be based on job-related evidence. A good process aims to be reliable, valid, fair, consistent and transparent. Professional guidance recommends clear and structured processes to reduce bias and improve the quality of selection decisions.

30. Selection Flow

Flow
HRP → Vacancy/Requirement → Job Analysis → Job Description & Specification → Recruitment Sources → Applications → Initial Screening → Shortlisting → Tests/Assessment → Interview → References/Pre-employment Checks → Final Decision → Offer → Joining/Onboarding

31. Selection Process

1. Receipt of applications.
2. Preliminary screening against minimum eligibility criteria.
3. Preparation of shortlist.
4. Selection tests, where appropriate.
5. Interview or other assessment methods.
6. Reference and/or pre-employment checks, as appropriate.
7. Assessment and comparison against predetermined criteria.
8. Final selection decision.
9. Job offer and appointment formalities.
10. Feedback, records and transition to onboarding.

32. Review of Applications

Application screening is the first major filtering stage. The organisation compares applications with the essential and desirable criteria in the job specification.

Application Blank

An application blank is a standardised form used to collect relevant information from candidates. It may ask about education, experience, skills, contact details, references and other job-related information.

Weighted Application Blank

A weighted application blank assigns different importance or scores to selected pieces of applicant information based on their relationship with successful job performance. It should be developed carefully using job-related evidence and should not rely on irrelevant personal characteristics.

> Example
>
> For a customer-service trainee, the organisation might assign structured scores for relevant experience, evidence of customer interaction, communication assessment and numerical reasoning. The scoring system should be applied consistently rather than changed from candidate to candidate.

33. Selection Tests

Selection tests are structured tools used to assess specific attributes relevant to job performance. The choice of test depends on the job and the evidence required.

Test Type	What It Measures	Example
Technical/Knowledge Test	Job-related knowledge	Accounting principles test for an accounts trainee
Aptitude/Ability Test	Reasoning or cognitive ability	Numerical reasoning test
Personality Test	Patterns of personality-related characteristics	Structured personality inventory
Skill Test	Ability to perform a specific task	Spreadsheet or data-entry task
Situational Test	Response to realistic work situations	Customer complaint scenario
Work Sample	Actual or simulated job performance	Prepare a financial report from given data

34. Selection Test Design

1. Start with job analysis and identify the competency or attribute to be assessed.

2. Define the purpose of the test.

3. Select or develop items/tasks that are clearly related to the job.

4. Prepare standard instructions and scoring rules.

5. Pilot the test where feasible.

6. Evaluate reliability and evidence of validity.

7. Administer the test consistently.

8. Record and interpret results using predetermined criteria.

Important principle

A test should not be used merely because it is popular. The organisation should be able to explain what the test measures, why that attribute matters for the job, how it is scored and what evidence supports its usefulness.

35. Reliability of Selection Tests

Reliability refers to the consistency of a measurement. A reliable selection test should produce reasonably consistent results when the same underlying attribute is measured under comparable conditions.

• Test–retest reliability: stability of scores over time.

• Internal consistency: consistency among items intended to measure the same construct.

• Inter-rater reliability: consistency between different assessors or raters.

36. Validity of Selection Tests

Validity concerns whether the selection method provides appropriate evidence for the intended inference or decision. In HR selection, the key question is whether the assessment is meaningfully related to the job requirements and performance.

• Content-related evidence: Does the assessment adequately represent important aspects of the job or competency?

• Criterion-related evidence: Are assessment results related to an appropriate measure of job performance?

• Construct-related evidence: Does the method appropriately measure the underlying attribute it claims to measure?

Easy distinction

Reliability = consistency.
Validity = appropriateness/accuracy of the intended measurement and decision.
A method can be consistent without being useful for the intended purpose.

37. Employment Interviews

An employment interview is a planned interaction in which an organisation collects information from a candidate and allows the candidate to understand the role and organisation. Interviews can be structured, unstructured, individual, panel, behavioural or situational.

38. Structured vs Unstructured Interview

Basis	Structured Interview	Unstructured Interview
Questions	Predetermined and job-related	May vary considerably
Scoring	Usually uses a common rating guide	Often more subjective
Comparability	Higher across candidates	Lower
Bias control	Generally better when well designed	Greater risk of interviewer discretion
Best use	Selection decisions requiring consistency	Exploratory conversation, subject to caution

39. Behavioural Interview

A behavioural interview asks candidates to describe past behaviour in situations relevant to the job. The underlying idea is that previous behaviour can provide useful evidence about how a person may respond in comparable situations, although it should not be treated as a perfect predictor.

Example question: “Tell us about a time when you had to resolve a difficult customer complaint. What did you do and what was the outcome?”

STAR approach for candidates

S – Situation: What was happening?
T – Task: What were you responsible for?
A – Action: What exactly did you do?
R – Result: What happened because of your action?

40. Situational Interview

A situational interview presents a hypothetical job-related situation and asks the candidate how they would respond.

Example: “A customer says that an amount has been wrongly debited from the account and is becoming angry. What steps would you take?”

41. Individual and Panel Interviews

Type	Meaning	Advantages	Limitations
Individual	One interviewer with one candidate	Simple; easier rapport	One interviewer may introduce personal bias
Panel	Two or more interviewers assess the candidate	Multiple perspectives	Can intimidate candidates if poorly conducted
Sequential/Multiple	Candidate meets interviewers separately	Different expertise can be considered	Longer process; inconsistent questioning can occur

42. Guidelines for Interviewers

1. Study the job description and specification before the interview.

2. Prepare a consistent set of core questions.

3. Ask only job-related and appropriate questions.

4. Create a professional and respectful environment.

5. Use open questions for detailed evidence and probing questions for clarification.

6. Listen actively and avoid interrupting unnecessarily.

7. Take factual notes rather than recording unsupported impressions.

8. Use predetermined rating criteria.

9. Do not allow one attractive or unattractive characteristic to dominate the entire assessment.

10. Give candidates an opportunity to ask questions and explain relevant information.

11. Record the final assessment promptly and retain appropriate documentation.

43. Common Interview Biases

Bias	Meaning	Example
Halo effect	One positive characteristic influences the whole evaluation	Excellent communication causes interviewer to overlook weak job evidence
Horns effect	One negative characteristic dominates judgement	A nervous opening leads to a poor overall rating
Similarity bias	Preference for people perceived as similar to the interviewer	Choosing a candidate because they share similar interests
First-impression bias	Early information dominates later evidence	Initial impression shapes the rest of the interview
Confirmation bias	Seeking evidence that supports an early belief	Interviewer asks follow-ups only to prove an initial opinion
Stereotyping	Judging based on group assumptions rather than individual evidence	Assuming ability based on age, gender or background

44. Pre-Employment Checks

Pre-employment checks are verification activities undertaken before appointment where they are relevant and lawful. Depending on the role, they may include education or qualification verification, employment history, references, identity documentation, professional credentials or other role-specific checks.

• Checks should be relevant to the role.

• Candidates should be treated consistently.

• Information should be handled confidentially and in accordance with applicable requirements.

• A discrepancy should be investigated fairly rather than automatically treated as proof of misconduct.

45. Assessment Centre

An assessment centre is a structured process in which candidates complete multiple exercises designed to assess several job-related competencies, usually with more than one assessor. It is commonly used for managerial, supervisory, graduate trainee and other roles where multiple competencies need to be observed.

Exercise	Competencies Commonly Observed
Group discussion	Teamwork, communication, listening, influence

Exercise	Competencies Commonly Observed
In-basket/in-tray exercise	Prioritisation, judgement, organisation
Role play	Communication, conflict handling, customer orientation
Presentation	Communication, analysis, confidence, structure
Case analysis	Problem-solving, analytical ability, decision-making
Simulation	Integrated behavioural and job-related competencies

Assessment-centre principle

Using several exercises and trained assessors can provide a broader evidence base than relying on a single interview. However, assessment exercises must still be job-related, properly designed and consistently scored.

46. Illustrative Case Study: Selecting an Accounts Officer

Vacancy: Accounts Officer in a medium-sized manufacturing company.

Job requirements: Commerce graduate, accounting knowledge, spreadsheet skills, attention to detail, communication with internal departments and ability to meet reporting deadlines.

Proposed process: (1) eligibility screening; (2) technical accounting test; (3) spreadsheet work sample; (4) structured behavioural interview; (5) reference/credential checks; (6) final scoring and decision.

Discussion: Why should the organisation use more than an interview? Which assessment has the strongest link to actual work? How can the organisation ensure that all candidates are evaluated on the same criteria?

MODULE INTEGRATION AND EXAMINATION SUPPORT

47. Integrated Example: A New Retail Store

A retail company is opening a new store and expects 40 employees to be required. HR begins by examining the store's operating hours, expected customer volume, service model and technology. This is part of HRP. It then conducts job analysis for positions such as store manager, cashier and sales associate. The resulting job descriptions and specifications guide recruitment. Applications are screened and suitable candidates are assessed through selection methods such as work samples, structured interviews and role-specific tests.

The example shows why the topics should be studied as a connected chain rather than as separate chapters.

Stage	Key Question	Output
HRP	How many people and what skills will be needed?	Workforce requirement/plan
Job Analysis	What does each job involve and what does the person need?	Job description and specification
Recruitment	Where and how can suitable applicants be attracted?	Applicant pool
Selection	Which applicants best meet the requirements?	Selection decision

48. Short Notes for Examination Revision

Human Resource Planning: A systematic process of forecasting and balancing future workforce demand and supply so that organisational objectives can be achieved.

Job Analysis: Systematic collection and analysis of information about job tasks, responsibilities, context and requirements.

Job Description: Written description of the job, its duties, responsibilities and related information.

Job Specification: Statement of the qualifications, skills, abilities and other characteristics required of the person.

Recruitment: Process of attracting potential candidates and creating an applicant pool.

E-Recruitment: Use of digital technologies and online channels in recruitment.

Inclusive Recruitment: Recruitment designed to provide fair opportunity and reduce unnecessary barriers and bias.

Selection: Process of assessing applicants and choosing the most suitable candidate(s).

Reliability: Consistency of measurement.

Validity: Evidence that a selection method appropriately supports the intended assessment or decision.

Structured Interview: Interview using predetermined job-related questions and consistent evaluation criteria.

Assessment Centre: Multi-exercise, often multi-assessor process for observing job-related competencies.

49. Important Distinctions

Do Not Confuse	Correct Distinction
HRP and Recruitment	HRP forecasts workforce needs; recruitment attracts applicants to meet identified needs.
Recruitment and Selection	Recruitment creates an applicant pool; selection evaluates and chooses applicants.
Job Description and Job Specification	Description focuses on the job; specification focuses on the person required.
Reliability and Validity	Reliability is consistency; validity concerns whether the method appropriately measures/supports the intended decision.
Internal and External Recruitment	Internal sources come from within the organisation; external sources come from the labour market.
Structured and Unstructured Interview	Structured interviews use predetermined questions/criteria; unstructured interviews allow greater interviewer discretion.

50. University Examination-Oriented Questions

A. Very Short Answer Questions

1. What is Human Resource Planning?

2. What is demand forecasting?

3. Define job analysis.

4. What is a job description?

5. What is a job specification?

6. Define recruitment.

7. What is e-recruitment?

8. What is inclusive recruitment?

9. What is a weighted application blank?

10. What is reliability?

11. What is validity?

12. What is a structured interview?

13. What is an assessment centre?

B. Short/Descriptive Questions

1. Explain the objectives and importance of HRP.

2. Discuss the major steps in the HRP process.

3. Explain any five methods of demand forecasting.

4. Distinguish between demand forecasting and supply forecasting.

5. Explain the methods of job analysis.

6. Distinguish between job description and job specification.

7. Discuss internal and external sources of recruitment.

8. Explain the advantages and limitations of e-recruitment.

9. What is inclusive recruitment? Explain ways to make recruitment more inclusive.

10. Explain the process of selection.

11. Discuss selection tests and their major types.

12. Explain reliability and validity in selection.

13. Distinguish between structured and unstructured interviews.

14. Explain the guidelines for effective employment interviews.

15. What is an assessment centre? Explain its major exercises.

C. Case-Based Questions

1. A company is expanding into a new city but has no reliable estimate of the number of employees it will require. Identify the HRP information needed and suggest forecasting methods.

2. A firm receives 5,000 applications for 50 vacancies. Design a fair screening and selection process.

3. A manager selects a candidate because the candidate attended the same college as the manager. Identify the likely bias and suggest safeguards.

4. An organisation uses a personality test for every job without checking whether it is relevant to job performance. Critically examine this practice.

51. Practical Classroom Activities

• Activity 1 – HRP: In groups, select a local business and prepare a one-year workforce plan for a hypothetical 20% expansion.

• Activity 2 – Job Analysis: Interview a person performing a familiar job and prepare a job description and job specification.

• Activity 3 – Recruitment: Create a recruitment advertisement for a Junior Accounts Executive using essential and desirable criteria.

• Activity 4 – Selection: Develop five structured interview questions and a 1–5 scoring rubric for the same job.

• Activity 5 – Bias Detection: Review a fictional interview scenario and identify at least three possible sources of bias.

REFERENCES AND FURTHER READING

Core Textbooks

1. Aswathappa, K. Human Resource Management: Text and Cases. McGraw Hill.

2. Dessler, G. Human Resource Management. Pearson.

3. Armstrong, M., & Taylor, S. Armstrong's Handbook of Human Resource Management Practice. Kogan Page.

4. Decenzo, D. A., Robbins, S. P., & Verhulst, S. L. Fundamentals of Human Resource Management. Wiley.

Professional and Official Sources Consulted

5. Chartered Institute of Personnel and Development (CIPD), Workforce Planning factsheet and strategic workforce-planning guidance. These materials emphasise balancing labour demand and supply and linking workforce planning with organisational strategy.

6. Chartered Institute of Personnel and Development (CIPD), Recruitment: An Introduction and Selection Methods. These materials cover recruitment, shortlisting, interviews, psychometric tests, work-sample assessments and assessment centres, with emphasis on fair, structured and job-related selection.

7. Ministry of Labour & Employment, Government of India, material relating to apprenticeship training and the Apprentices Act. Legal provisions should always be checked against the latest applicable Indian legislation and official notifications before teaching or applying legal requirements.

Teaching note
This study material focuses on the three requested syllabus areas—Human Resource Planning and Job Analysis, Recruitment, and Selection. It is written for UG Commerce learners and uses simplified explanations while retaining key HR concepts. For legal or regulatory questions, students should consult the latest official government notification or statute in force.